

WHIDBEY ISLAND HORSE COUNCIL
Meeting minutes: September 16th, 2026

The meeting was called to order at 6:30 by coordinator Sally Garratt. Fifteen people were present plus one person attended on zoom. The minutes of the last meeting were reviewed and approved as read.

WEBPAGE/DIRECTORY:

Karena was not present but the group discussed some suggestions for inclusion in the Equine Directory including: farm sitters, trailer hauling, and other equine related subjects. Barb prepared a “liability waiver” for inclusion in the directory. Jessi offered to help with the website and Directory. Adam offered to coordinate development of the emergency preparedness section of the webpage including info from his Backcountry Horseman presentation. He also offered to contact Jerry Lloyd regarding the emergency rescue equipment and the possibility of creating a team to handle large animal rescues.

EQUINE ECONOMIC IMPACT SURVEY

Leslie discussed the importance of the survey to future development of the Island. She noted that gathering information for the survey is challenging because of privacy concerns. She stressed the need to have our webpage finished so that we can have a professional online presence when working on the survey. Bruce offered to purchase the 2023 American Horse Council economic impact study report and appendices for use and guidance in conducting our local Island survey. Leslie mentioned that about six other states have studies available for reference. People interested in working on this project should contact Leslie.

GREENBANK FARM EQUINE DEVELOPMENT PLAN

The Group discussed development possibilities at Greenbank Farm. Sandy offered to research how Sunset Farms (near the Border) handles horse activities as a possible model for the development of GBF. Sunset Farms is a county park and the horse facilities are run by the “friends of Sunset Farms”, a non-profit organization. GBF is owned by the Port of Coupeville and must maintain agricultural uses, which could include horse activities. The group considered forming a non-profit partnership similar to Sunset Farms to develop facilities at GBF starting with an arena and an obstacle course. The Port Commissioners have not been contacted yet.

The meeting was adjourned at 8pm. The next meeting will be held on October 7th at 6:30 at the Race Road Fire Station.

